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BRIEFING

CAMBRIDGE IGCSE • FIRST LANGUAGE ENGLISH • 0500

What Changes *in 2027*

A teacher's briefing on the new 0500 exam: what is different, what it means for your classroom, and what to do this term.

- ◆ Both papers at a glance
- ◆ Classroom actions for each change
- ◆ Five ready-to-use lesson starters
- ◆ The six changes that matter
- ◆ Year 10–11 planning map
- ◆ Department meeting checklist

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SECTION 1

The new exam at a glance

Two written papers, each 2 hours and 80 marks, each worth 50% of the grade. Some centres enter candidates for the Coursework Portfolio (Component 3) instead of Paper 2.

Paper 1 · Reading *three texts, about 1,400 words*

Question	Text	Task	Marks
Q1	A	Comprehension: explicit and implicit meaning (tests all five reading skills)	20
Q2(a)	B	Selective summary, max 120 words	15 (10R + 5W)
Q2(b)	B	New: writer's attitudes and opinions	5
Q3	C	Short answers, including 2-mark word meanings (key words in bold)	10
Q3	C	Language task, 200–250 words	10
Q4	C	Extended response (letter, report, journal, speech, interview or article), 250–300 words	20 (10R + 10W)

Paper 2 · Directed Writing and Composition

Question	Task	Marks
1(a)	New: structured question on 1–2 texts (550–650 words): analyse and evaluate ideas, including how the writer influences readers	5
1(b)	Directed writing: speech, letter, article or report, 250–350 words	35 (10R + 25W)
Section B	Composition: one of four titles (two descriptive, two narrative), 350–450 words	40